

Consultation Reply Public Health

PLANNING CONSULTATION RESPONSE Application No 96.74218.COU Proposal Change of use from taxi office (class (e)(iii)) to Indian takeaway (sue generis). Address 60 Ash Grove, Balby, Doncaster, ZZ17 0TB

Consultee Public Health Consultation assessment and justification: Hexthorpe and Balby North Ward, PHE (<redacted_date>-25)1 • 26.2% of reception aged children are overweight and 14.0% are obese. • In year 6 this rises to 44.5% and 33.6% respectively. • 27.3% of children are living in poverty • 28.1% of older people are deprived

Impact on local obesity Work by the National Obesity Observatory found that there are strong associations between deprivation and the density of fast food outlets, with more deprived areas having more fast food outlets per population. The national average of takeaways is 0.96 per <redacted_date> population2. Hexthorpe and Balby North Ward has a population of 12,<redacted_date> and has 23 hot food takeaways; the average number of hot food takeaway for the population size is 1.89, which is well above the national average, therefore Hexthorpe and Balby North Ward is already well served with hot food takeaways. The Chief Medical Officer has recommended the use of evidence based interventions at an individual and population level to modify or regulate the fast food environment. Early findings from recent research has shown that across Doncaster the fast food environment seems to exhibit a strong influence on population level obesity with those most likely to be exposed to fast food outlets more likely to be obese4. Relevant policies

The opening of another fast food takeaway would contribute to the obesity of the local population. This is contrary to Government commitments in the Healthy Lives, Healthy People Strategy: A Call to Action on Obesity which encourages Local Authorities to use their planning levers to limit the growth of fast food takeaways5. It does not support Doncaster's Health and Wellbeing Strategy (<redacted_date>-<redacted_date>) priority for obesity which aims to develop "a whole systems approach to obesity which promotes and positively contributes to creating a healthy and equitable living environment; by providing access to healthy, affordable locally produced food, opportunities to be physically active and, where appropriate, by restricting opportunities for unhealthy eating." Equally, the opening of another fast food takeaway does not support Doncaster's Borough Strategy, 'Doncaster Delivering Together', particularly in relation to the 'Compassionate and Healthy' and 'Fair and Inclusive' Wellbeing goals. Doncaster Council is adopting the following Marmot Principles to guide our actions moving forward and support Doncaster residents to live healthy, happy and longer lives: • 'Ensure a healthy standard of living for all', • 'Create and develop healthy and sustainable places and communities'6

The increased access to fast food takeaways in the borough would therefore be contrary to Doncaster's adopted Borough Strategy. Planning and Health The link between planning and health has been long established. The National Planning Policy Guidance (NPPG) builds on this by stipulating that planning and health need to be considered together in two ways; in terms of creating environments that support and encourage healthy lifestyles and in terms of identifying and securing facilities needed for care7. The built and natural environments are major determinants of health and wellbeing. The importance of this is highlighted in the overarching objectives "social objective" to support strong, vibrant and healthy communities of the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF). Chapter 8 of the NPPF Promoting healthy and safe communities aims to achieve healthy, inclusive and safe places by enabling and supporting healthy lifestyles, especially where this would address identified local health and wellbeing needs – for example through the provision of local shops, access to healthier food, allotments etc.8

National Planning Practice Guidance (NPPG), 'Healthy and safe communities' stresses the importance of the planning system in promoting healthy lifestyles. Para 003 outlines a healthy place as one which promotes a reduction in health inequalities for people of all ages and creates an environment which supports healthy behaviours. Para 004 outlines how planning can create a healthier food environment, including seeking to limit the proliferation of particular uses where evidence demonstrates this is appropriate. Para 004 also has particular regard to issues such as the proximity of such establishments to locations where: • children and young people congregate • evidence indicates high levels of obesity, deprivation and general poor health • over concentration and clustering of certain uses within a specified area and, • odours and noise impact, traffic impact and refuse and litter.9

Locally, the adopted Local Plan Policy 24: Food and Drink Uses states that proposals solely for a hot food takeaway will only be supported where: • there is no clustering or cumulative impact resulting from an over concentration of hot food takeaways in an area. Clustering will occur where more than 10% of units, in a parade of Main Town Centre Uses, will be used as a hot food takeaway; and 1 Hexthorpe and Balby Ward, PHE (<redacted_date>-25)

Local health, public health data for small geographic areas - Data | Fingertips | Department of Health and Social Care Local health, public health data for small geographic areas - Data | Fingertips | Department of Health and Social Care 2 Obesity and the environment, Public Health England, <redacted_url> ast_Food_map.pdf 3 Ward Level Population Estimates, Office for National Statistics <redacted_date> Ward-level population estimates (Experimental Statistics) - Office for National Statistics (<redacted_url>) 4 Hot Food Takeaways: an evidence based review for Doncaster, Doncaster Council <redacted_date> 5 Healthy Lives, Healthy People: A call to action on obesity in England, DoH <redacted_date> <redacted_url> h_130487.pdf [last accessed

<redacted_date>] 6 Doncaster Delivering Together Prospectus <redacted_date>-<redacted_date>, p.18, <redacted_url> %20Single%20Pages%20-%<redacted_url> 7 <redacted_url> Paragraph: 001 Reference ID:53-<redacted_phone> 8 MHCLG, National Planning Policy Framework <redacted_date> <redacted_url> NPPF_July_2021.pdf 9 National Planning Policy Guidance, 'Healthy and safe communities', <redacted_date>, <redacted_url> • the number of approved hot food takeaways within the ward is less than the UK national average of hot food takeaways per 1,000 population. Policy 24 also states that proposals which are located within 400 metres of a school, sixth form college, community centre or playground will not be supported unless the opening hours are restricted until after <redacted_date> during weekdays and there are no over the counter sales before that time. The explanation to Policy 24 goes on to say that obesity is a complex issue and not solely affected by individual behaviours but influenced by a number of social and environmental issues. There are concerns regarding the combination of the proliferation of hot food takeaways in the borough and the levels of obesity. Particularly in childhood obesity, which is a growing threat to children's health in the borough. Policy 24 seeks to manage and control the provision of hot food takeaways particularly in specific areas. Chapter 13 of the Local Plan and specifically Policy 50 highlight the priorities for improving and promoting strong, vibrant and healthy communities by ensuring a high quality environment is provided with local services to support health, social and cultural wellbeing. This includes developments which contribute to creating high quality places that support and promote healthy communities and lifestyles and controlling the location of, and access, to Food and Drink Uses.¹⁰ Considering the evidence laid out the Director of Public Health has concluded that access to takeaway food in the Hexthorpe and Balby Ward is sufficient to serve the population. In conclusion, the proposal does not accord with NPPF/NPPG and the Doncaster Local Plan policies 24 and 50. Therefore, in order to support planning policy and the principles of other borough strategies this proposal is recommended for refusal. Consultation Conditions: 1. Consultation Informatives: 1. Planning obligations 1. 10 Doncaster Local Plan <redacted_date>-<redacted_date>, <redacted_url>